A preposition is a word used to link nouns, pronouns or phrases to other words within a sentence. Prepositions are usually short words and they are placed before the nouns.

Look at the following sentences.

i) The English language is vital **in** the medical field.

ii) He climbed **up** the stairs to get **into** the terrace.

Note that the words in bold letters in the above sentences link the two parts of the sentence. These words are called Prepositions.

Look at some more examples of **prepositions and prepositional phrases.**

on, off, up, in, out, above, below, over, under, to, from, with, without, before, after, at, during, according to, ahead of, a part of, from, as far as, in spite of, owing to, in addition to, in case of, in front of, but for, on account of, on behalf of, with reference to etc.

Sometimes, a sentence can end with a preposition. Read the sentences given below.

- This seat is not very comfortable to sit _____.
- My father gave me some pictures to look _____.
- Was it worth waiting _____?

The preposition 'in', 'at', and 'for' occur at the end of the sentence.This is acceptable in usage.

A) Fill in the blanks in the following sentences with appropriate prepositions.

(i) In case _____ difficulty, you should refer _____ a dictionary and then respond _____ the question.

(ii) The clothes that he has put _____ are very impressive. He is going _____ his hometown to pay homage _____ the village head.

(iii) The nearest hospital _____ this place is _____ a distance of twenty kilometers. You can reach it either _____ car or _____ a bicycle.

B) Complete the following paragraph by filling in the blanks with suitable prepositions and read the paragraph aloud for better understanding of the use of prepositions.

Mr. Beek of New Jersey has invented a floating life-preserver, which gives complete protection (1) _____ people who have been shipwrecked. The upper section is large enough (2)____ the wearer to be able to move his head and arms (3) _____,and a month's supply (4)_____ food and drinking water can also be stored (5) _____ it. The cover can be closed in rough weather, and the wearer can see (6) _____ the window in the front, and breathe (7) _____ a curved pipe. The life preserver is made (8) _____ water proof cloth attached (9) _____ circular metal tubes, which protect the wearer (10) _____ sharp rocks and hungry fish.

C) Fill in the blanks in the following sentences, using prepositions if necessary.

(i) The new machines are quite

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